

Overview

Best Kids, a DMV area nonprofit, helps children in foster care build successful futures through lasting mentorships. Created in 2001 by Todd Leibbrand, they are the first pilot program in DC to volunteer mentors dedicated to children in foster care. The program is based on the core values of fun, connections, equity, impact, consistency, and love. DCivitas primarily worked with Best Kids in the educational sector of the program and in creating, maintaining, and improving other programs. DCivitas assisted in fundraising, marketing, and operation of events for the nonprofit helping to raise more funds for Best Kids to hire more tutors and improve other programming.

Challenges

Best Kids faced a few challenges, especially in obtaining the funds necessary to run the organization. In partnership with DCivitas, Best Kids hoped to improve their fundraising and marketing as well as their operations. In order to do this DCivitas needed to help Best Kids find new sponsors and fundraisers, make more long-term plans, increase their marketing reach, funding, and partnerships with organizations. Above all, the nonprofit needed to be kept operational. In tackling this project, DCivitas had to overcome challenges in the novelty of fundraising work and discerning Best Kids' main drivers for costs. In order to ensure maximum success DCivitas made an effort to maintain close collaboration with Best Kids throughout the project.

Solutions

The main solution to these challenges was to maintain a close relationship with Best Kids. Maintaining strong communication with them was imperative to work efficiently and to be able to execute our goals. While some of the DCivitas team had never worked with grants before, the project managers and other returners were able to help their teammates learn how to apply for grants. DCivitas's 3 main goals were to create a marketing plan, to market fundraisers, and to help with preparing for Best Kids's fundraising events.

Impact

In May 2023, Best Kids had their 5k Fundraiser where the DCivitas team came to volunteer and help with activities set out for the kids. All the fundraising prep that DCivitas and Best Kids had been collaborating on for months was finally realized. Through the 5k, Best Kids was able to raise a lot of money to help continue their work. In addition to partnering with DCivitas, Best Kids partnered with GAFAS who also helped with the event which was rewarding to see the Georgetown community coming together to support Best Kids. As for more short-term goals, the team was able to fundraise by applying for different grants. They were also able to spread the word about

Best Kids through social media marketing, effectively bringing in more revenue through increasing engagement with the fundraising events.